FINTECH RULES SWEDEN OCT 2026

THE CHEAT SHEET

A white paper on Sweden's fintech rules, cut into cards. Where the gaps are, who's exposed, and what to do. Short, dry, and scannable.

Made with AI and not fact-checked. Verify before you rely on it. The fine print is on the last card.

BASED ON:
OPPORTUNITIES IN REGULATION, A WHITE PAPER

GTM HELP FOR FINTECHS:
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THE WHOLE
PAPER

// 002

THE EU REWROTE THE RULES. SOME PAGES ARE STILL BLANK.

Sweden has to follow the new EU rules. The blank pages sit where the money is:

Embedded finance
Buy now pay later
Crypto
Open banking
AI lending

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THE WHOLE PAPER

// 003

A HOUSE MID-RENOVATION.

Walls up: the laws are passed.

Wiring half done: little official guidance.

Residents: already living there, flicking switches to see what happens.

The paper's pitch: find the gaps, build carefully, and be ready when the rules land.

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WHO'S
WHO

// 004

SIX REFEREES.

FI (Finansinspektionen)
Sweden's financial supervisor. Rarely explains the rules before kickoff. Blows the whistle anyway.

Riksbank
The central bank. Keeps pointing at one load-bearing wall: Swish.

IMY
Data protection. Guards decisions made by machines.

DIGG
Agency for Digital Administration. Watches AI products on the market.

ARN
National Board for Consumer Disputes. Where scam complaints get mixed results.

EBA, ESMA, EIOPA
EU-level supervisors. They write the fine print.

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THREE
PILES

// 005

EVERY RULE FITS IN ONE OF THREE PILES.

1. LIVE NOW

Speed limits are posted. PSD2, DORA, MiCA, AI Act, CCD2.
Comply today.

2. COMING SOON

Road under construction, signs on order. PSD3 + PSR, FIDA, maybe the e-krona.
Start preparing.

3. MISSING OR VAGUE

A roundabout with no signs. Everyone guesses who yields. Embedded finance, BNPL checks, AI oversight, crypto outside MiCA, bank APIs, scam refunds, Swish.
The pile to study. Old maps would say “here be fines”.

PSD2

LIVE SINCE 2018

IN PLAIN WORDS

Payment rules. Lets licensed apps into your bank account, with your permission.

Think of it as: a key to the bank's back door. The door often sticks.

STATUS:
LIVE IN SWEDISH LAW

PSD3 + PSR

LATE 2026–2027

IN PLAIN WORDS

PSD2's sequel. Tighter login security, better bank APIs, more refunds for scam victims. Then 18 months for Sweden to write it into law.

Think of it as: same plot, more liability.

STATUS:
NEAR-FINAL TEXT. PSR APPLIES DIRECTLY

DORA

17 JAN 2025

IN PLAIN WORDS

Your IT must not fall over, and you must prove it. Covers IT risk, incident reports, testing and suppliers.

Think of it as: a fire drill that never ends.

STATUS:
APPLIES SINCE 17 JAN 2025

MiCA

30 DEC 2024

IN PLAIN WORDS

Licences for crypto service providers and token issuers. Skips DeFi and most NFTs.

Think of it as: a driving licence for crypto. Some vehicles are missing from the list.

STATUS:
FULLY APPLIES SINCE 30 DEC 2024

AI ACT

AUG
2026

IN PLAIN WORDS

Rules for AI. Credit scoring counts as high-risk: registration, checks, human oversight. Bans applied from Feb 2025.

Think of it as: a permit for robots that hand out loans.

STATUS:
HIGH-RISK DATE AS THE PAPER STATES IT. CHECK IT: CARD 037

CCD2

NOV 2025

IN PLAIN WORDS

Consumer credit rules, now covering buy now pay later. Credit checks, marketing limits, BNPL disclosures.

Think of it as: Buy Now, Paperwork Later.

STATUS:
IMPLEMENTED. EU DEADLINE WAS NOV 2025

FIDA

2027 AT THE EARLIEST

IN PLAIN WORDS

Open banking for your whole financial life: mortgages, savings, investments, pensions, insurance.

Think of it as: PSD2, extended cut.

STATUS:
STILL BEING NEGOTIATED

E-KRONA

NO DATE SET

IN PLAIN WORDS

A possible Swedish central bank digital currency. The Riksbank says it can be built. Issuing it is a political call.

Think of it as: technically ready, politically parked.

STATUS:
NO DECISION TO ISSUE

ON THE
PODCAST

// ON AIR

KNOW ONE OF THESE RULEBOOKS INSIDE OUT?

WE'RE LOOKING FOR GUESTS

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THE CORE
PROBLEM

// 014

ONE PRODUCT. SEVERAL COMPANIES. ONE NAME ON THE LICENCE.

The rules follow the licence. The customer follows the brand.

Picture it: a relay race where only the first runner is registered. Someone drops the baton on leg three. The referee has one name on the clipboard.

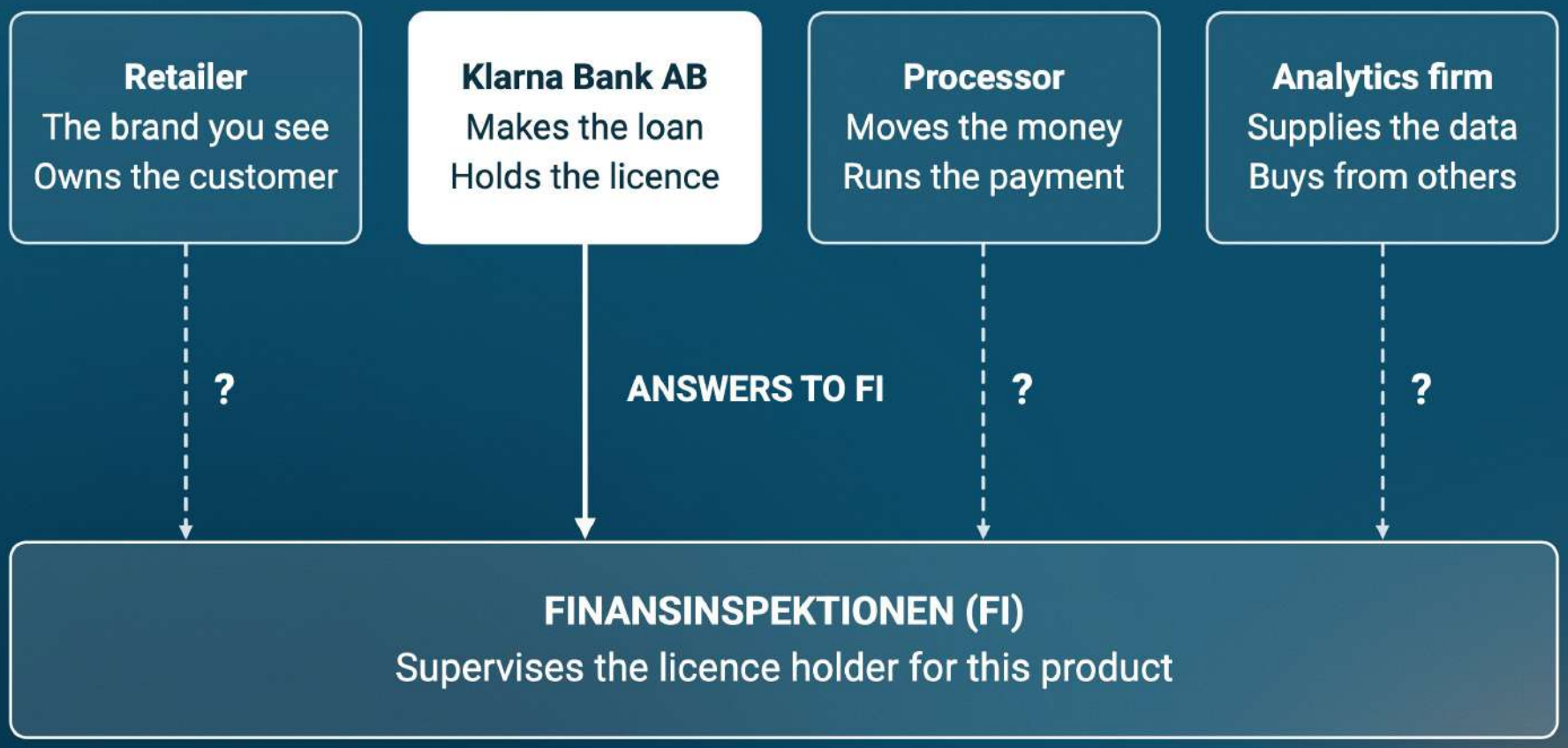
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THE CORE PROBLEM

// 015

FOUR COMPANIES RUN THE LOAN. ONE ANSWERS TO FI.

You buy a sofa and pick pay later. DORA covers the IT side of this chain. No rule clearly says who answers when a customer gets hurt.



Solid line: set by the licence. Dashed: not clearly defined by any current rule.

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A SHOP SELLS YOU A LOAN. WHO ANSWERS FOR IT?

EMBEDDED FINANCE

Picture it: pizza ordered through an app arrives cold. Who do you call?

Status: no FI guidance. The UK has rules for this. Sweden has no equivalent.

A CREDIT CHECK FOR A SANDWICH.

BNPL CREDIT CHECKS

How hard must you check someone before a 14-day, 500 kr purchase?

Status: CCD2 is live. FI hasn't said what “proportionate” means.

THE GAPS
3 OF 7

// 018

ONE LIFEGUARD. TEN THOUSAND SWIMMERS.

AI LENDING

What counts as “meaningful human oversight” at thousands of loan decisions an hour?

Status: the AI Act says high-risk. FI, IMY and DIGG all have a say. Nobody has said who leads.

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LICENCES FOR DRIVERS. NONE FOR SELF-DRIVING CARS.

CRYPTO OUTSIDE MiCA

MiCA skips DeFi, most NFTs, and stablecoins used to settle payments.

Status: nothing specific. Visa and Mastercard are building stablecoin settlement anyway.

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THE GAPS
5 OF 7

// 020

THE DOOR IS LEGALLY OPEN. IT IS ALSO STUCK.

BANK API QUALITY

Banks must let apps in. Nobody set how well the door has to open.

Status: the rules exist, enforcement is thin. PSD3 and PSR tighten it.

THE GAPS
6 OF 7

// 021

WHO PAYS WHEN THE STRANGER WAS VERY CONVINCING?

SCAM FRAUD

A customer is tricked into approving a payment. Courts and ARN have given mixed answers.

Status: mandatory refunds, like the UK's 2024 regime, arrive with PSD3 and PSR in about 3 to 4 years.

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EVERY CAR IN THE COUNTRY ON ONE BRIDGE.

SWISH CONCENTRATION

Most retail payments run on one rail, owned by a group of banks. What if it goes down?

Status: the Riksbank has flagged it. No law proposed as of mid-2026.

NOT A YES.

ALSO NOT A NO.

ONE RULE FOR ALL SEVEN

When FI says nothing, it has said nothing. Build as if either answer could arrive, and keep the paperwork ready.

THE FINE PRINT:
FI CAN ACT AFTER THE FACT

ON THE
PODCAST

// ON AIR

BUILDING IN ONE OF THESE GAPS?

FINTECHS WANTED

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FOUR WHO ARE SWEATING.

Small payment firms in embedded chains
DORA now, PSD3 fraud rules next, AI Act on top.
Three backpacks, one small person.

BNPL firms without a bank licence
Credit checks built for normal loans, applied to tiny ones. Klarna is the exception: bank licence since 2017.
Paperwork bigger than the purchase.

Crypto firms switching to MiCA
The old FI registration isn't a MiCA licence. Apply or wind down.
New exam, old certificate.

Anyone using AI to lend
Nearly every Swedish fintech lender. High-risk rules, no manual.
Homework due, no textbook.

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FOUR WHO ARE SMILING.

BaaS providers with solid compliance
E.g. Treezor, Bankable. Others pay them to carry the compliance load.
Selling forklifts at a heavy-lifting contest.

Open banking firms built for bad APIs
E.g. Tink, now Visa. Their own backups already work around sticky bank doors.
Brought their own ladder.

Fraud detection firms
E.g. Ravelin, Featurespace. Fraud losses shift onto payment firms.
Selling locks after the insurance rules changed.

RegTech and compliance-as-a-service
Too many rules for small firms to handle alone. AI Act checks are barely served in Sweden.
Tax accountants in April.

THE CHAIN

01 **CARD ISSUANCE**
A bank lends its card range to a fintech. How closely must the bank watch? No guidance.

02 **CARD NETWORKS**
Stablecoin settlement sits outside MiCA and payment rules.

03 **MERCHANT ACQUIRING**
Fraud costs are split by contract. PSD3 will collide with those contracts.

04 **PROCESSING**
Mostly a market gap: few build well for Swish, MobilePay and Vipps.

05 **OPEN BANKING** HOT
Right to access: yes. Quality rules: not yet.

06 **RECONCILIATION AND TREASURY**
DORA applies now. FIDA's data demands come later.

07 **FRAUD AND RISK**
Does fraud AI count as high-risk under the AI Act? Unclear.

08 **EMBEDDED FINANCE** HOTTEST
Fastest growing, least defined. Nobody has mapped who answers for what.

READ IT AS:
A PAYMENT PASSES THROUGH UP TO 8 LAYERS

THE REFEREE EXPLAINS THE RULES BEFORE THE MATCH.

FI GETS CHATTY

FI publishes guidance on embedded finance and AI lending, and makes an example of one or two BNPL or crypto firms. Like the UK's “Dear CEO” letters.

Wins: firms that talked to FI early, and RegTech sellers.
Loses: firms that read silence as a yes.

SPEED CAMERAS INSTALLED. NOT SWITCHED ON. YET.

FI STAYS BUSY

FI is swamped by PSD3, DORA and MiCA. No real guidance until 2028 or later.

Wins: fast movers who can change course quickly.
Loses: firms that assume the gap is permanent.

Fine print: FI can still act after the fact.

THREE FUTURES
SCENARIO C

// 029

LOCAL CHEF. EU RECIPE BOOK.

BRUSSELS TAKES OVER

EU-wide regulations like PSR, and maybe FIDA, leave little room for Swedish tweaks.

Wins: large firms built to run across the whole EU.
Loses: firms whose edge is knowing Swedish quirks.

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WHAT TO DO
INFRA PROVIDERS

// 030

SELL UMBRELLAS WHILE THE FORECAST SAYS RAIN.

PAYMENT RAILS, BAAS, APIS

Sell DORA help now. Build AI Act compliance support next.

Why: the paper expects FI to start supervising AI lending in 2026 or 2027.

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WHAT TO DO
EMBEDDED FINANCE

// 031

LABEL YOUR FUSE BOX BEFORE THE ELECTRICIAN SHOWS UP.

EMBEDDED AND WHITE-LABEL FIRMS

Write down the chain:

Who holds the licence
Who supervises the partner
Who handles complaints
What happens when it breaks

Why: not required yet. It's the first thing FI will ask for.

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WHAT TO DO
BNPL AND CREDIT

// 032

ASK THE REFEREE ABOUT OFFSIDE BEFORE THE GAME.

BNPL AND CONSUMER LENDERS

Document your credit check and why it's proportionate. Talk to FI before FI talks to you.

Why: FI hasn't said how it will supervise CCD2 for BNPL. Early contact puts you in a better spot.

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WHAT TO DO
VCS AND ADVISERS

// 033

CHECK THE PLUMBING BEFORE ADMIRING THE PAINT.

CHECK THE BORING PARTS

Accountability chains
Fraud liability
AI Act classification

Why: the paper says the real risk hides there, away from the crypto and AI headlines.

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WHAT TO DO
OPEN BANKING

// 034

LAY THE PIPES BEFORE THE WATER ARRIVES.

FIRMS EYEING FIDA

Start building data cleaning, consent handling and integrations now.

Why: FIDA won't land before 2027, and this work takes longer than a quarter.

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WHAT TO DO
ONE MORE THING

// GTM

GOOD PRODUCT. GOOD GAP. NOW PEOPLE NEED TO HEAR ABOUT IT.

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BY THE NUMBERS

4	Big Swedish banks: Swedbank, SEB, Handelsbanken, Nordea
9.5bn	Swish transactions in 2024, per the paper. Sanity-check it: card 037
€1.8bn	Reported price Visa paid for Tink, 2022
€50bn+	Trustly payment volume in 2023 (company figure)
18 mo	Time Sweden gets to write PSD3 into law once it's adopted
3–4 yrs	The paper's estimate until mandatory scam refunds arrive

SOURCE:
THE WHITE PAPER'S OWN FIGURES

THE CALENDAR

2017	Klarna gets a banking licence
2018	PSD2 in Swedish law
JUN 2023	EU proposes PSD3, PSR and FIDA
AUG 2024	AI Act in force
30 DEC 2024	MiCA fully applies
17 JAN 2025	DORA applies
FEB 2025	AI Act bans apply
NOV 2025	CCD2 deadline. Riksbank flags Swish
AUG 2026	AI Act high-risk rules, per the paper
OCT 2026	**WE ARE HERE**
2026–2027	FI expected to supervise AI lending
LATE 2026–27	PSD3 and PSR adoption expected
2027 OR LATER	FIDA, at the earliest
2028 OR LATER	Guidance arrives, if Scenario B plays out

HOW TO READ IT:
FILLED DOT: HAPPENED. HOLLOW: EXPECTED

DOUBLE-
CHECK

// 037

CHECK THESE BEFORE THEY END UP ON A SLIDE.

Swish, 9.5 billion a year
About 900 Swishes per Swede per year. Check it against Swish's own figures.

DORA “entered into force” 17 Jan 2025
It entered into force in Jan 2023. 17 Jan 2025 is when it started to apply.

Visa and Mastercard as DMA gatekeepers
The 2023 designations were big tech platforms. This one looks wrong.

Fraud AI as “high-risk”
The AI Act's credit-scoring category excludes fraud detection. Shaky.

AI Act high-risk date, Aug 2026
The EU proposed delays in late 2025. Check where that landed.

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SELF-TEST

1 **Which law makes firms prove their IT won't fall over?**
DORA.

2 **Why is a 500 kr BNPL purchase a regulatory headache?**
CCD2 demands a credit check. Nobody defined “proportionate” for tiny, short loans.

3 **In embedded finance, who carries the obligation?**
The licence holder, even when another firm owns the customer.

4 **What does FIDA add on top of PSD2?**
Data beyond payment accounts: mortgages, savings, investments, pensions, insurance.

5 **Name two things MiCA doesn't cover.**
DeFi with no central provider, and most NFTs.

HOW TO USE:
COVER THE GREY. ANSWER OUT LOUD.

SELF-TEST

6 **Besides FI, which two agencies have a say over AI lending?**
IMY (data protection) and DIGG (AI market surveillance).

7 **The open banking gap in one line?**
The right to access exists. Quality isn't enforced.

8 **What's the trap in Scenario B?**
Treating regulatory silence as permanent permission.

9 **Why does the Riksbank worry about Swish?**
One rail carries most retail payments. No specific law covers its resilience.

10 **Where does the paper say investors underestimate risk?**
Accountability chains in embedded finance, and fraud liability under PSD3.

ANSWERED OUT LOUD?
COLLEAGUES WILL ASSUME YOU'RE ON A CALL.

READ ME.

VERIFY BEFORE YOU USE

THE FINE PRINT

This glossary is a general introduction based on the source document. Proposed legislation, implementation timelines, and regulatory responsibilities should be verified against current official sources before being relied upon for legal or business decisions.

This packet was made using AI and has not been fact-checked. Please keep that in mind.

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